

BOSCH Established 1960

Infusing professionalism into India's industrial sector, 500 trained apprentices from Bosch have been bridging the skill gap for companies across the globe every year for almost 50 years

COURSE OF ACTION

Bosch Limited's operations in Bangalore are almost as old as the country itself. The world's largest private industrial giant and a billion dollar corporation has done more than its share for the country, since 1951. Early on in its career, Bosch India (then Motor Industries Co Ltd) started an apprenticeship programme in 1960, which today churns out 500 trained graduates every year from its unique curriculum.

Bosch supplies technology and services to various sectors such as automotive, industrial, consumer goods and IT. In its early years, however, Bosch saw a need for skilled manpower and launched an apprenticeship programme, where they decided to have a dedicated centre to train young people. What initially started as a centre to train their own staff, has today become a beacon for in-

dustrial professionals. With a training centre in Bangalore, 90 batches have graduated till now with impressive placements. The students have gone on to become industrialists, or managing directors, such as R. Ramakrishnan, MD of GMR Agro-Business. According to C.M. Ashwathappa, head of Bosch Vocational Centre, "Our students' success speaks for our institution. Over 500 students who have settled in the US and Australia are contributing to the country with the foreign exchange earnings they send back home."

The course is for students who have passed Class X, or for engineering graduates, and varies between three and four years. The programme

offers specialised training in seven trades, including hydraulics and pneumatics, CNC technology, mechatronics, metrology and cutting tool technology, tool and dye-making, personal computers and AutoCAD. "We lay great emphasis on practical training," explains Ashwathappa. Their most unique concept is that of the production-oriented shop, where each apprentice has to handle actual job orders received from various departments of Bosch, and has to deliver after checking for quality. "This trains them not only in terms of the delivery mechanism, but also ensures quality control," adds Ashwathappa.

63.2 per cent
of the total investment in the telecom sector was contributed by the private sector during 2008-09.

by Pankti Mehta

C.M. Ashwathappa 53, Head, Bosch Vocational Centre

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